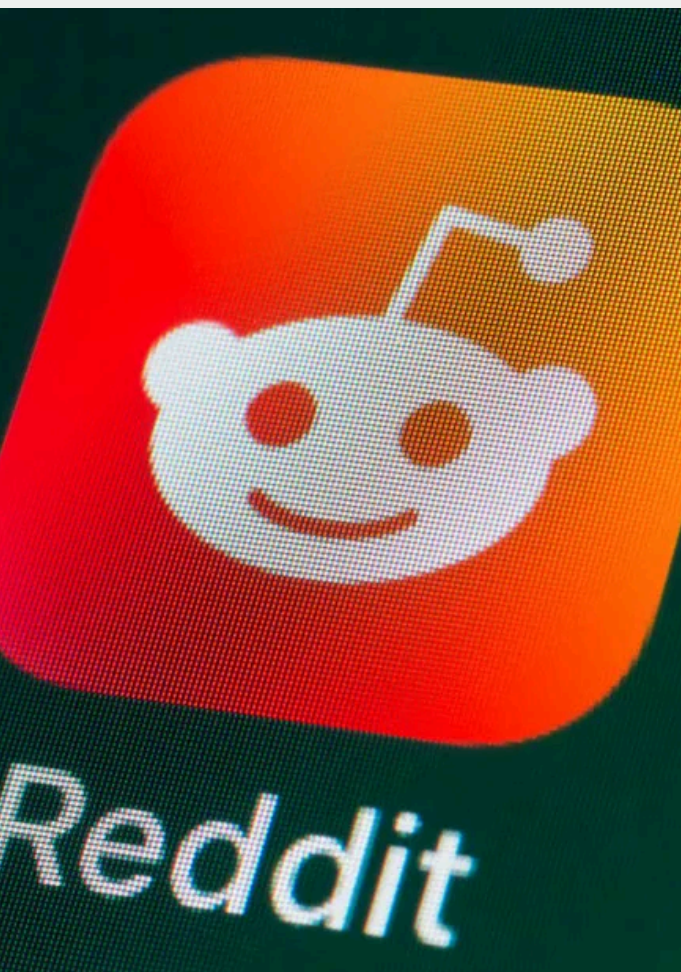


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Reddit plans to unify its search interface as it looks to become a search engine

Ivan Mehta — 5:04 AM PDT • August 1, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: STOCKCAM / GETTY IMAGES

With search today so full of AI slop and sites spamming SEO tricks, it's not unusual for people to append "reddit" to their queries in hopes of finding useful answers to their questions. Google has tried to integrate results from [Reddit in its search interface](#), and taking notice of the trend, Reddit has been experimenting with its [own AI search](#) as well. But the company has loftier ambitions: It wants to become the go-to search engine people use.

Reddit's CEO Steve Huffman said as much during its second-quarter conference call on Thursday: "Reddit is one of the few platforms positioned to become a true search destination. We offer something special, a breadth of conversations and knowledge you can't find anywhere else."

Huffman noted that Reddit's search function has more than 70 million weekly users, and its AI-powered Q&A product, Reddit Answers, is now used by 6 million people.

Reddit Answers is currently available in a dozen countries, and the company plans to expand it globally, as well as give it prominent placement in the site's interface. The company eventually wants to unify the core search function with Reddit Answers, and redesign its app to have the search box be more prominently visible.

"We're unifying those [Reddit search and Reddit Answers] into a single search experience, and we're gonna bring that front and center in the app. So, whether you're a new user opening the app for the first time or a returning user opening the app, that search box will be present immediately," Huffman said on the call.

People are increasingly being presented chat-styled search interfaces from products like ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google's new AI mode. Reddit understandably believes that tapping its rich trove of user posts and comments to help people find answers will help make its search function more useful.

Reddit reported a positive second quarter, with revenue jumping 78% to \$500 million from a year earlier. The company launched [two new ad tools](#), which let marketers use Reddit data to spot trends and leverage comments about brands in their campaigns.

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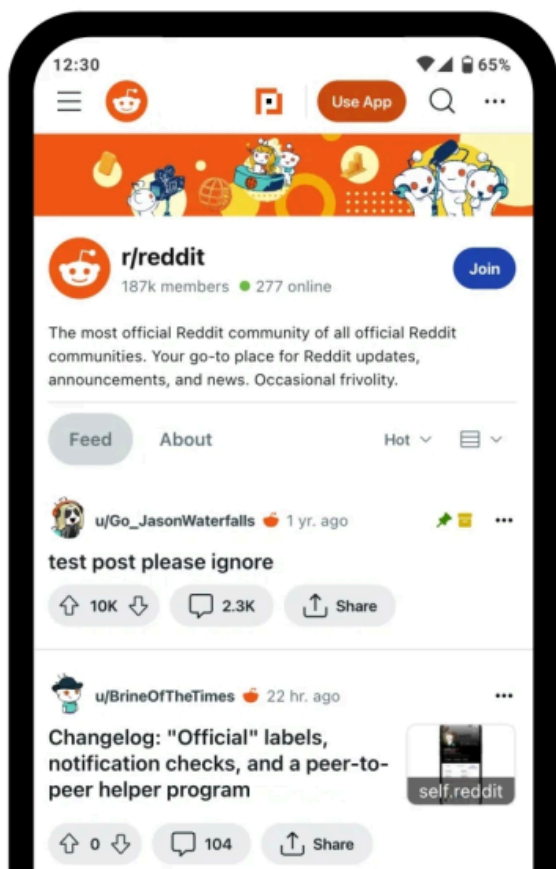


IMAGE CREDITS: REDDIT

APPS

Reddit updates its site design for logged-out users

Ivan Mehta — 1:45 AM PDT · August 1, 2023

Reddit is rolling out a number of updates to its website for logged-out users, including improved performance, a more helpful search results page and better communities and related post suggestions.

The company said in [a post](#) on Monday that people are coming to the Reddit website from different search engines to find relevant content on a topic posted by users, so it is improving the experience for the folks visiting the service occasionally or for the first time.

Reddit said it has simplified the search result page on the site with a new layout. It noted that on mobile, the search result page now prioritizes posts

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over other elements.

The platform has also made design changes to the landing page to let people browse through content without searching. On the top, there are six trending posts instead of four shown previously. The company also mentioned that posts now have increased title sizes with an improved inset for images and videos.



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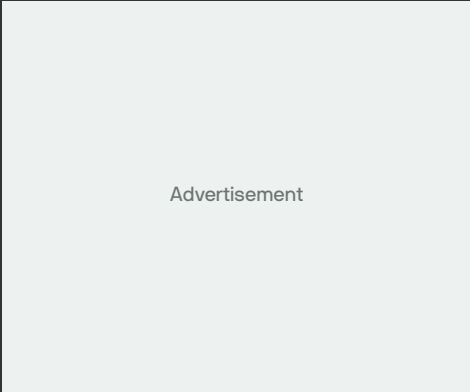
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On desktop, Reddit’s new site shows a sticky sidebar, so you can scroll through the content independently to highlight relevant communities or posts. When logged-out users visit a subreddit’s landing page, they will see in the sidebar information about the community, such as the community

banner, description, number of members and rules of the community. Reddit specified that while a lot of subreddits have custom styling, logged-out users won't see that at the moment.

Additionally, Reddit is adding performance adjustments to the logged-out site experience to make its pages load twice as fast as before.

This is the social network's second update rollout for the logged-out experience this year. In March, it made the [pages screen reader-friendly](#) along with making the web pages cleaner.



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The latest updates will be available across both mobile and desktop web experiences, the company said. The mobile site, however, still shows an annoying popup asking users if they want to open a post in the app, as many users pointed out under the announcement post. I have also seen the popup appear as soon as I open a Reddit link on the mobile browser.

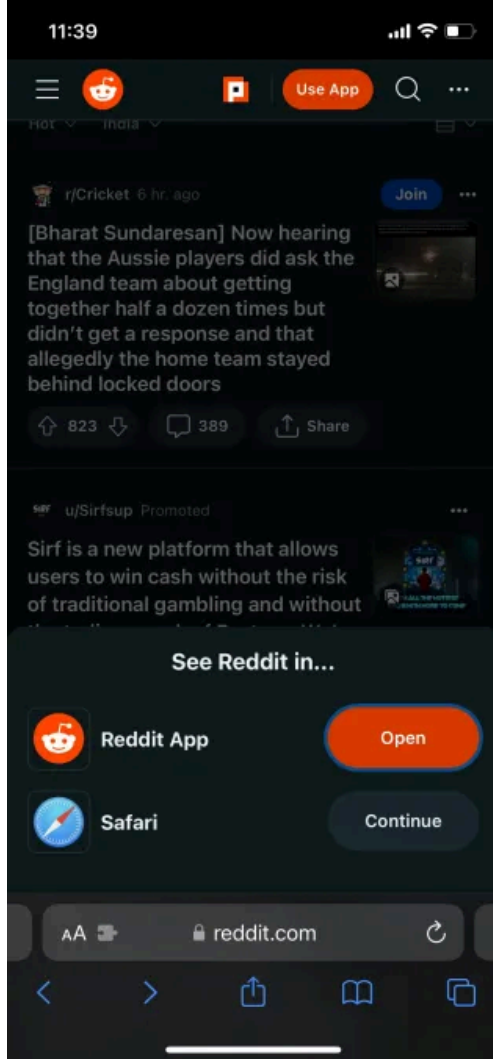


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Last week, the company [announced that it is testing its own verification mark](#) through “official” badges with limited accounts. It also promised that in August, the platform is introducing new accessibility features for its apps to make the screen reader-friendly. However, the communities protesting Reddit’s API changes — which forced a lot of third-party apps to shut down — were [not pleased](#) by these promises.

Reddit’s change to accommodate users without an account is a welcome change. Last month, Twitter briefly [forced users to have an account](#) to see any tweet before removing that requirement. While users can see particular tweets without logging in, they can’t explore the site. Meta’s Threads app also lets you see accounts and posts, but it doesn’t have a fully functional web service. The decentralized social network Mastodon is an exception and lets you explore different posts on [the mastodon.social](#) server.

The platform’s change to its web experience comes as more users are looking to use [Reddit as a search engine](#) — even if they are [appending “Reddit” to their Google search queries](#). Plus, it’s another surface for the company to show ads as it [focuses on profitability](#).

Topics: [Apps](#) [Reddit](#) [Social](#) [steve huffman](#) [web design](#)

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications including Huffington Post and The Next Web....

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IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

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Reddit braces for life after API changes

Ivan Mehta — 5:37 AM PDT · July 4, 2023

Reddit has had a tumultuous month after [announcing changes to its data API](#). In the last month, [Reddit's CEO gave interviews defending the company's decision](#), the social network had fights with developers and moderators, and the platform saw [a large number of subreddits going dark](#) and later protesting in different ways.

Latest in Social

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Given that the API changes and rate limits went into effect on July 1, Reddit is preparing for a new chapter with fewer third-party apps, more focus on its own apps and an unhappy community. In this story, we will take a look at what has happened in the last month and what the future looks like.

Reddit’s controversial June

Early in June, Christian Selig, the developer of a popular Reddit client called Apollo, said that he had a call with Reddit management. The API pricing would cost him nearly \$20 million per year to run his app. This post and the company’s changes were followed by many third-party Reddit app developers sharing similar concerns about their future.

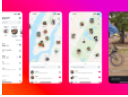
As a reaction, many subreddits decided to go dark on June 12-14 to protest these changes. Meanwhile, Selig said that [he would be shutting down Apollo by the end of the month](#). Other apps like [Reddit is Fun and Sync for Reddit](#) also announced closures. The company’s [CEO Steve Huffman held a dramatic AMA](#) on the site and defended his decision saying that Reddit would “continue to be profit-driven until profits arrive,” while attacking Selig.

Huffman gave a [series of interviews](#) as thousands of subreddits went dark. He called protesting moderators the “landed gentry” and talked about redefining moderator rules so the community can vote them out if needed. Huffman also complained that while third-party developers made money, Reddit had to bear an infrastructure cost of \$10 million per year.

Later, Selig and other developers [hit back](#) to debunk Reddit’s claim about trying to work with developers. Selig said in [his post](#) that in one of the calls with the company earlier this year, he asked about plans for changes in APIs, and the company said there won’t be any.

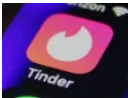
While the June 12-14 protest had an effect on the site’s traffic and even Google search, the company maintained the stance that there was no effect on the revenue. As a result, some subreddits extended the blackout — some even asked their community members to decide the future course of their community. As Reddit admins threatened the moderators to reopen subreddits, these communities adapted [alternative forms of protests](#), like posting pictures of John Oliver, deciding on blackout days and changing the focus of the community.

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Ivan Mehta - 17 hours ago

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Lauren Forristal - 18 hours ago



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As [The Verge](#) reported last month, r/TranscribersOfReddit, a volunteer subreddit that provided transcription for media, decided to shut down. Additionally, the report noted that moderators relied on third-party apps for accessibility tools, which are not available in Reddit's app.

The company did allow apps like RedReader, Dystopia and Luna to be exempt from API changes because of accessibility features. However, [moderators](#) have pointed out that these apps might not have adequate moderator tools.

What's happening now

When some communities decided to stay private, Reddit admins [sent messages to moderators](#) asking them to open up [within 48 hours](#). As a result, communities like r/Photography and r/homeimprovement have opened up, but with either relaxed rules or in restricted mode. r/pics is now NSFW despite the company saying wrongly marking a community with that label is against the platform's rules. r/videos is posting text descriptions of videos. So the protest is still going on in some way.

Apps like [Apollo, Sync for Reddit, BaconReader and Boost for Reddit](#) have [shut down](#). Meanwhile, some developers for apps like [Relay, Now for Reddit](#) and [Narwhal](#) are making their apps free to use while exploring a subscription model.

Moderators are still finding ways to protest the changes. r/IAMA moderators said they will no longer coordinate celebrity interviews, as reported by [The Verge](#).

Over the weekend, Reddit announced that it is bringing [accessibility improvements to features like moderation tools](#). However, r/Blind moderators [posted over the weekend](#) that there are bugs in the official Reddit app that have made it impossible to steer the community. The subreddit also demanded that the social network should appoint a "Chief Accessibility Officer" to make the platform more inclusive and easier to use.

In its blog post titled "Key Facts to Understanding Reddit's Recent API Updates," the company said that it has conducted an external audit on accessibility, but didn't share more details on it. The social media platform said that it has exempted apps like RedReader, Luna, and Dystopia from API charges. This way, accessibility-focused apps will remain free. But the company didn't share the criteria for an app to qualify for the exemption.

As for the company, it is now focused on achieving profitability as [rumors of an IPO](#) are intensifying. In an interview with [The Verge](#), Huffman said that an IPO is "something we'd like to do someday" but there were "a few things I'd like to do with Reddit before we get there."

Some communities have started to move to new places like [Kbin](#) and [Lemmy](#). However, the communities on those platforms are still small compared to subreddits with thousands or even millions of users.

Reddit’s recent set of actions have not wiped out the third-party ecosystem entirely, but the company has made it hard for developers to create a sustainable model without incurring significant costs. These changes have also created unpleasant experiences for communities and pushed them to use tools that they might not have wanted to.

The company seems to be adamant about its decisions, and new changes to the API pricing structure seem unlikely.

Topics: [Accessibility](#) [Apps](#) [community](#) [Reddit](#) [Reddit API changes](#) [Social](#)

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Reddit communities adopt alternative forms of protest, as the company threatens action on moderators

Ivan Mehta

7:12 AM PDT · June 19, 2023

Multiple subreddits are adopting alternative methods of protesting, such as publishing only one kind of post, changing the topic in focus, and days when the community turns private.

A lot of these communities took part in the Reddit blackout from June 12-14 to protest [Reddit's API rule changes](#), which could effectively kill a lot of third-party apps. As the company — and its CEO Steve Huffman — decided not to make any changes, subreddits started thinking about going dark indefinitely.

However, Reddit pointed out that moderators must keep the community open. Plus, they can't decide that their community should go dark without a public vote. The company even sent [messages](#) to moderators saying that they will be removed if they all continue to participate in the blackout.

To get around the [moderator removal](#) action, multiple communities are running polls to decide what type of posts are allowed on the subreddit. They are also [relaxing some rules](#) — because of the changes, moderators won't have certain tools available to them, making their job more difficult.

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

Some of the biggest communities like [r/pics](#), [r/aww](#), and r/GIF decided to post John Oliver pictures and [GIFs](#). In a tweet, Oliver approved this move.

Dear Reddit, excellent work. Attn: r/pics — have at it...

— John Oliver (@iamjohnoliver) [June 17, 2023](#)

In the case of r/aww, the community is also allowed to post pictures of [Chiijohn](#). r/iPhone decided to post pictures celebrating [“dashing” Tim Cook](#).

There are some truly bizarre forms of protest, as well:

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- [r/Shitposting](#) banned posts with the letter k.
- [r/Wellthatsucks](#) is now a subreddit about vacuum cleaners.

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- [r/Nofans](#) is now a passive PC cooler subreddit.
- [r/Interestingasfuck](#) removed a lot of all rules apart from asking members to not break site-wide rules.
- [r/Memes](#) is allowing only Medieval / Landed Gentry memes. This is in response to [Huffman's "Landed Gentry" comment](#) about protesting subreddits.
- [r/PokemonGo](#) is now allowing pictures of John Oliver, Pikachu, or Spark.
- [r/Horny](#) is now a "Christian Minecraft server."
- [r/Steam](#) members are posting about actual steam.
- [r/HarryPotter](#) is now referring to Huffman as Voldemort.
- Some subreddits such as [r/Showerthoughts](#) are determining close days for the community.

[Reddit CEO lashes out on protests, moderators and third-party apps](#)

While these methods are innovative and amusing, we'll have to see if Reddit management shows any tendency to budge.

In recent interviews, Huffman [vehemently defended the company's API rule changes](#) and said that it wants to be profitable. He also suggested that these protests were spearheaded by a "small group that's very upset" and it didn't have any impact on the company's revenues. Through these public votes, communities are trying to prove that a large number of people are unhappy with the changes made by Reddit.

If you are a subreddit moderator or Reddit employee who wants to talk about the ongoing situations, you can contact the reporter at im@ivanmehta.com.

Topics: [Apps](#) [developers](#) [Reddit](#) [Social](#) [steve huffman](#)










Ivan Mehta

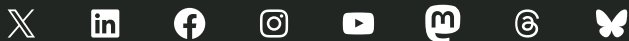



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